

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The Court of Protection Paralegal role at Penningtons Manches Cooper appeals to me because it sits at the intersection of legal procedure and direct client responsibility in a context where getting the detail right genuinely matters for vulnerable people. My background in case management, client communication and procedural document work at BCLP and Citizens Advice gives me a practical foundation for the day-to-day management responsibilities the role describes.

At Citizens Advice I act as a primary point of contact for clients across welfare, housing, family and debt matters. That means taking detailed factual statements, identifying evidential gaps, drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules and keeping confidential case records in order, all within tight deadlines and often with clients who are in difficult circumstances. Managing a client's affairs in a Court of Protection context requires the same combination of procedural accuracy and careful communication, so the role is a direct extension of work I am already doing rather than a sideways move.

At BCLP, where I spent six months in International Arbitration and six months in Real Estate Disputes, I was responsible for maintaining structured electronic case files, tracking procedural deadlines across several active matters and coordinating documents under time pressure. In the arbitration team I became the only junior supporting a significant submission shortly before its deadline, which required me to coordinate outstanding actions across the team and with an external translator, and to escalate nothing that did not need escalating. A partner and associate told me my performance at that stage was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. The file management and deadline discipline that produced that outcome is directly transferable to managing clients' affairs in a Court of Protection caseload.

I want to work at Penningtons Manches Cooper specifically because the Court of Protection team works on matters where the legal process has a direct and practical effect on a client's daily life. My LLM dissertation examined how GDPR obligations interact with personal autonomy across jurisdictions, and my Citizens Advice work regularly involves assessing capacity-adjacent questions around decision-making and vulnerability. This role feels like a logical next step from that work, in a team where the client contact is substantive and the paralegal has real case responsibility from the outset.

I am based in the Reading area and the Basingstoke location works well for me.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva